

1 _____ BILL NO. _____

2 INTRODUCED BY _____
3 (Primary Sponsor)

4 A BILL FOR AN ACT ENTITLED: "AN ACT REVISING LAWS RELATED TO STATE AID TO PUBLIC
5 LIBRARIES; REQUIRING PUBLIC LIBRARIES TO PROVIDE MATCHING FUNDS; PROVIDING FOR
6 CERTIFICATION OF MATCHING FUNDS; AMENDING SECTION 22-1-327, MCA; AND PROVIDING AN
7 EFFECTIVE DATE."

8
9 BE IT ENACTED BY THE LEGISLATURE OF THE STATE OF MONTANA:

10
11 **Section 1.** Section 22-1-327, MCA, is amended to read:

12 **"22-1-327. State aid -- per capita -- per square mile.** (1) The commission shall distribute grants to
13 public libraries and public library districts on a per capita and per square mile basis.

14 (2) The total amount of annual per capita and per square mile funding to public libraries for each
15 fiscal year is the base amount of 50 cents multiplied by the total number of residents of the state as determined
16 by the most recent decennial census of the population produced by the U.S. bureau of the census.

17 (3) The amount determined under subsection (2) is statutorily appropriated, as provided in 17-7-
18 502, from the general fund to the commission for distribution as state aid to public libraries.

19 (4) (a) A recipient of money pursuant to this section shall provide matching funds in cash, not in-
20 kind contributions. The match must represent \$1 in value for each \$1 of the grant.

21 (b) The match may not be met by utilizing other money made available by the state or the federal
22 government. Matching money must be contributed by local or tribal governments.

23 (c) To receive funding pursuant to this section, a certification must be provided by a responsible
24 official to confirm compliance with subsection (4)(b) and 22-1-326(3). (Subsections (2) and (3) terminate July 1,
25 2029--sec. 4, Ch. 621, L. 2023.)"

26
27 **NEW SECTION. Section 2. Effective date.** [This act] is effective July 1, 2025.

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